

KATHA STUDIO

Goat of the Solar Wind

A Ladakhi tinkerer and a goat with a solar saddle race a sandstorm to bring light back to a school that winter is trying to erase.

Book 08 · Mountain adventure · Nubra Valley

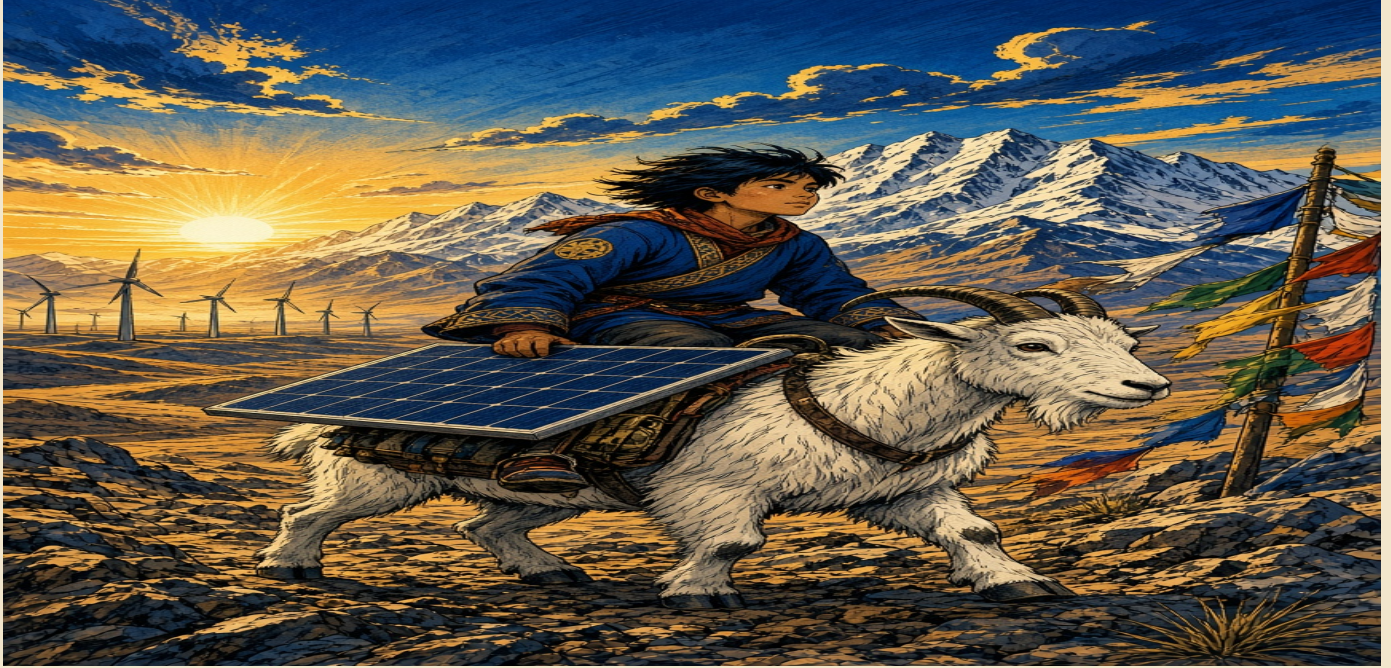
Lead: Tashi Dolma · 22 pages



Original Indian graphic book · For personal reading

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Sunrise in Nubra looks like a match struck against the Himalaya.

Tashi Dolma is seventeen, repairs things other people call dead, and has a goat named Kalsang who believes in voltage the way monks believe in patience.

NARRATOR

“Wind here is a teacher. It does not care if you took notes.”

WHOOSH



The saddle is her invention: light panels, old batteries, prayer-flag wiring that is only slightly theological.

Village aunties trust her because she fixed the butter-churn motor and did not lecture them about progress. Kalsang chews a wire, is scolded, chews a biscuit instead.

TASHI

“If it works, it is science. If it is pretty, that is a side effect.”

SPARK



The school's batteries fail in a week of cloud that feels personal.

Tashi inventories every working cell in three hamlets. The map of power looks like a thin necklace. She decides to walk the necklace with a goat.

HEADTEACHER

“Children can learn in the dark. They should not have to.”

CLICK



A sandstorm stands up on the dunes like a brown god with poor boundaries.

They run anyway. Running toward weather is a family habit. Her grandmother crossed worse for a library book, a story Tashi uses as fuel.

TASHI

“Kalsang, if we die, I am blaming your snack schedule.”

ROAR



Mid-storm, a panel cracks. Tashi tapes it with cloth meant for a winter sleeve.

Kalsang plants his feet in the way of goats who have read the land longer than engineers. They angle the remaining panel like a sail toward a rumour of sun.

TASHI

“Sorry, jacket. The school is colder than a shoulder.”

RIP



A truck is stuck, tourists arguing with GPS, GPS arguing with God.

Tashi does not take their power bank. She takes their extra water and leaves them a cairn pointing to the road they actually wanted. Kalsang refuses a selfie, which improves the century.

TOURIST

“Is there a charger in this century?”

BEEP

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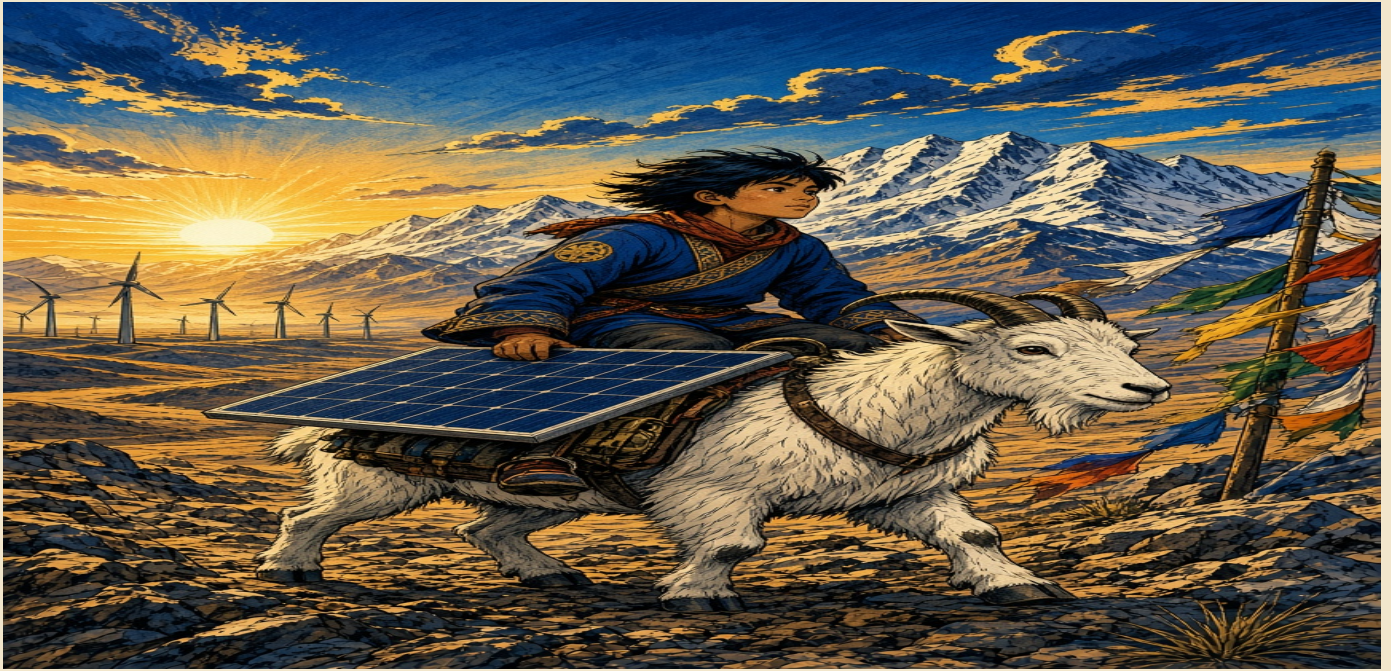
The storm thins. The school is a dark tooth on the valley.

They plug the saddle into the tired battery bank. Light returns like a shy guest, then like a festival. Children cheer in two languages and one wordless yell.

HEADTEACHER

“You look like a proverb with dust in its teeth.”

GASP



Night class happens: fractions, a song, a debate about whether goats can be engineers.

Tashi draws a circuit on the blackboard. The chalk squeaks. Someone falls asleep and is allowed to, because darkness had been stealing sleep all week.

CHILD

“Kalsang sir should get a stamp.”

LAUGH



Morning. A monk offers butter tea and a warning about pride.

Tashi starts a notebook titled OTHER HANDS. She will teach two younger kids the solder, even if they burn a hole in a sock. Socks are replaceable. Knowledge of sockets is not.

MONK

“Fixing light is good. Becoming the only light is a trap.”

SIP



A company wants to brand the goat.

Tashi says Kalsang is not a campaign. The executive writes DISRUPTIVE LOCAL PARTNER and flies away. The valley, unbothered, continues to be high.

EXECUTIVE

“Imagine the campaign. Authentic. Elevating. Limited-edition trekking merch.”

PING



Winter closes one road. The other road becomes a rumour.

They build a small library of charged batteries labelled with jokes. When a joke is bad, the battery still works, which is a useful lesson about standards.

TASHI

“Then we store summer in boxes, like pickle.”

WIND



Kalsang falls sick. Tashi forgets every circuit.

The vet is a day away. The aunties arrive with herbs and insulting nicknames that have healed worse. Kalsang lives, vindicated, and steals a glove as tax.

TASHI

“Eat. If you die I will have to talk to people more.”

BLEAT



A second storm, smaller, as if copying homework.

The two apprentices take the saddle this time. Tashi watches from the school steps with her heart in her throat and her hands in her pockets on purpose.

NARRATOR

“Copying is how weather and students both improve.”

GUST



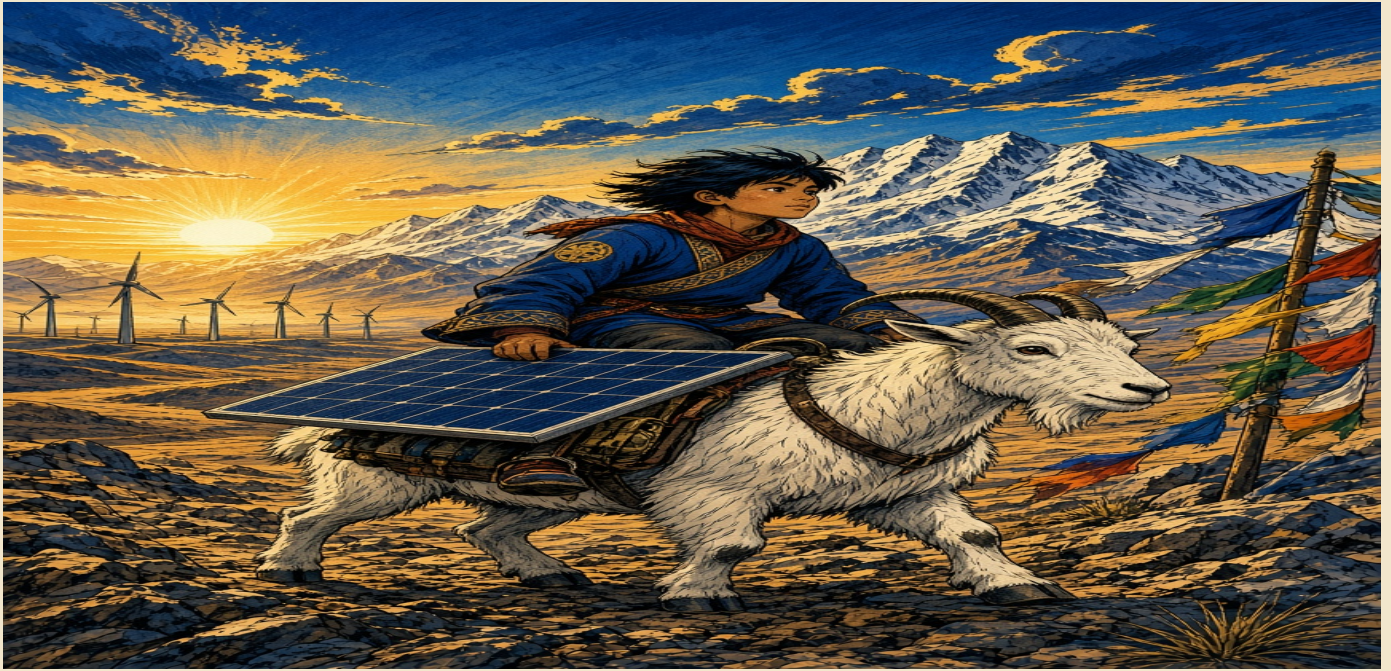
They succeed badly — light flickers, then holds.

Tashi says if it holds, it is allowed. She writes the song in the notebook under OTHER HANDS, because methods should be honest about their ingredients.

APPRENTICE

“We taped it with a song. Is that allowed?”

HUM



Stars over Nubra are so sharp they look like they could cut wire.

She lies on her back beside a goat who smells of dust and victory. The school hums. Humming is a kind of prayer that does not require anyone to be impressive.

TASHI

“Good. We might need them as spare sun.”

STILL



Her father, a driver, comes home and checks the panels like a man checking a child's forehead.

Tashi promises nothing of the sort and then sleeps twelve hours, which is a kind of promise.

FATHER

“Do not become so useful they forget you are young.”

PAT



In Leh, a workshop invites her to speak. She brings Kalsang, who eats a name-tag.

Someone from a ministry takes notes. Someone from a village takes her number. She prefers the second number.

TASHI

“The goat is the co-author. Cite him or the circuit fails.”

MURMUR



Back home, the children draw Kalsang with rays like a small sun that chews.

Tashi does not say wind cannot be fixed, only met. She says start with a torch. Starting small is how mountains are crossed.

CHILD

“When I grow up I will fix wind.”

COLOUR



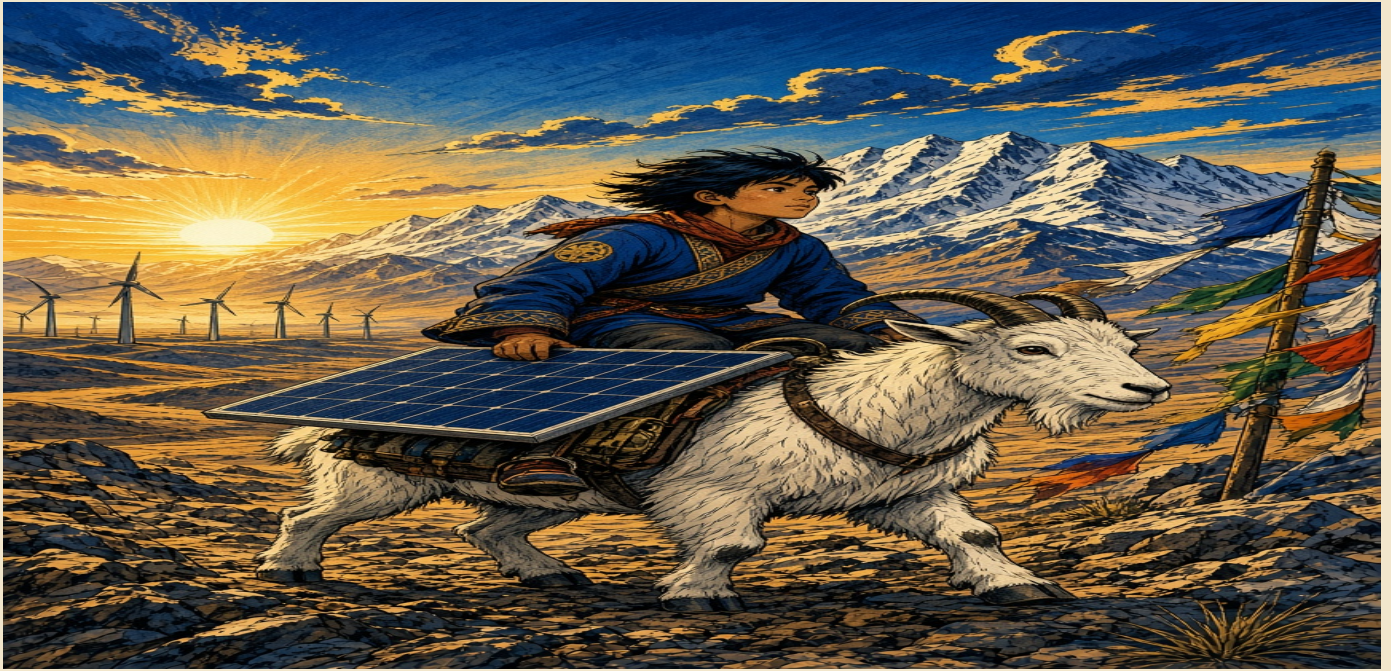
She oils the saddle, patches the cracked panel properly, returns the winter sleeve cloth as a patch of honour on the jacket.

The jacket looks ridiculous and beloved. Perfect.

TASHI

“See? The school gave you a medal.”

STITCH



Wind again, teacher again, no exam, only weather.

The valley does not get easier. It gets shared. And a girl and a goat with a solar saddle keep a school from becoming a rumour, which is one of the better uses of light.

NARRATOR

“Tashi Dolma, mechanic of leftover sun.”

WHOOSH



Last bell of the term rings on stolen sunshine.

Laughter. Batteries full. Snow on the high edges like a white comment in the margin of the world.

HEADTEACHER

“Homework: thank the goat and the girl, not in that order if you are afraid of horns.”

BELL



They walk home slower than the storm required, because slow is a kind of wealth.

He chews the hat-threat thoughtfully. The sun, professional as ever, keeps hitting the panels as if it had been in on the plan from the first match-strike morning.

TASHI

“Kalsang, if you chew the wiring I will make you a hat.”

BLEAT